



MONTHLY UPDATE

Equatorial Guinea: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-10 · 17 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-10 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

July 2026 was a month of institutional moves rather than delivery. The government [adopted a consolidated action plan](#) of 35 strategic objectives on 31 July that names recovering the .GQ domain as a sovereignty measure, [signed the Malabo Convention](#) on 28 July, [halted the TELGESA merger](#) pending an audit, and [authorised Starlink offshore](#) for American oil companies only.

Two things carried past the month's close. On 5 August the [Treasury Single Account committee](#) approved a five-phase roadmap, and on 7 August a [State Secretariat for Artificial Intelligence](#) was taken by the outgoing head of the state telecoms infrastructure operator.

Infrastructure

GETESA signed a [network contract with Huawei](#) on 9 July 2026 covering the modernisation the operator set out in May – 5G, eSIM, public Wi-Fi and fibre reactivation. The [independent outlet Radio Macuto](#) reported the arrangement on 15 July as a rescue of GETESA alongside the creation of TELGESA, and criticised the procurement as opaque.

At a working session on 22 July with the commission examining state-participation companies, Vice-President Nguema Obiang Mangué [ordered an audit of GECOMSA](#) – its financial position, the value of its assets and liabilities and its outstanding debts – before the definitive merger agreement with Loita Group creating TELGESA is signed.

The Minister of Transport, Posts and New Information and Communication Technologies [signed a temporary Starlink authorisation](#) on 28 July at a ceremony in the Palacio del Pueblo, permitting North American companies to use the service for operations on the high seas within jurisdictional waters, and handed it to the Minister of Hydrocarbons with the oil companies operating in the country present. A negotiating commission meeting the same day [heard that type-approval and the competences of the company and the regulator ORTEL remain undefined](#); a first phase serves public bodies, airport terminals and selected companies, and extension to individual subscribers is conditional on the negotiations concluding, which the executive justifies on security grounds.

The same ministry published [terms of reference for a public tender](#) on 29 July for a full technical diagnostic of existing digital terrestrial television infrastructure and its regularisation, rehabilitation, commissioning and operational transfer. It is Treasury-financed, and no contract value, tender deadline or switchover date is stated.

Digital public infrastructure

The Comité Nacional de la Cuenta Única del Tesoro, chaired by the prime minister, [approved a work programme and institutional roadmap](#) at the Presidency on 5 August 2026. The general census of all state bank accounts is complete; the new financial-management model will be built on AMS/X and SINTAG, both already used by the BEAC, interconnected with the Treasury's public-finance systems; and implementation runs in five phases with entry into production in the first quarter of 2027. No cost, implementing agency or supplier is stated.

INEGE opened a three-day validation workshop on 27 July at the Ministry of Finance, Budgets and National Planning on the project document, resource-mobilisation advocacy strategy and social-communication strategy for the [fifth population census and the first agricultural census](#), with UNFPA and FAO technical support and around fifty representatives of ministries, the National Assembly, the UN system, the AfDB, the World Bank, WHO and CEMAC. Decree 25/2025 of 3 March 2025 authorises both operations; the last population census was in 2015.

A GITGE study of the ministries, [reported on 2 July](#), put interoperability at about 15%, big data at about 21% and data analysis at about 10%.

Governance and regulation

Reporting on 2 July set out the provisions of [Ley 7/2024 of 23 December 2024](#) as it takes effect: minors under 14 may not access or belong to social networks without parental consent, their data may not be requested or published without express authorisation, the dissemination of any person's data, photographs, videos or files without express written consent is prohibited, and identity usurpation through false profiles for illicit ends is criminalised. The law creates ANCIC under the Presidency and is stated to draw on the Budapest and Malabo conventions.

The Minister of Foreign Affairs [signed the Malabo Convention at Addis Ababa on 28 July 2026](#), on the margins of the 49th Ordinary Session of the Executive Council. The AU status list as of 2 February 2026 recorded no signature, no ratification and no deposit for Equatorial Guinea, so the Chamber of Deputies' vote of 25 March 2026 was a domestic authorisation to ratify taken before the country was a signatory; no instrument of ratification is on file.

The ministry's second extraordinary directive council [adopted a consolidated July–December 2026 action plan](#) of 35 strategic objectives under three national priorities, one of them restoring sovereignty over the national digital space including the .GQ domain. Named measures include a Comisión Nacional de Negociación to recover the domain and a requirement that frequency licence fees and registration charges be paid in full into the Public Treasury. The plan goes to the interministerial council and then to the Council of Ministers, which decides which measures are recorded and funded.

The commission on state-participation companies [heard candidates on 29 July](#) for director-general and deputy posts at GITGE, ANDEGE, INSESO and Gepetrol Servicios against stated criteria, with appointments provisional for six months. [EITI data collection for the 2024 report](#) opened at Malabo on 30 July as the last outstanding measure before validation of the IMF Staff-Monitored Programme.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

On 7 August 2026 Óscar Ondo Ngomo left the director-generalship of GITGE, which he had held for thirteen years, to become [Secretary of State charged with artificial intelligence](#) at the Ministry of Transport, Telecommunications and Civil Aviation; the account describes the portfolio as newly named at that level. Salvador Nguema Funtam took over at GITGE with a new deputy, the outcome of the July selection process.

The consultancy AVANTE brought public institutions, banks and technology firms to the Hotel Anda China in Malabo on 22 July with the backing of the national development agency ANDGE. Panellists included the ministry's director-general for artificial intelligence, GITGE's technical director and BANGE's deputy head of digital and electronic banking; [GITGE's deputy director-general presented doctoral findings](#) on big data, interoperability and digital identity in the public administration, arguing that the constraint is structural gaps and elapsed time rather than technology.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

Nothing in the window bears on inclusion, capacity or finance: no appropriation, disbursement, training cohort or access figure was published.

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